

Seleeke Flingai, PhD, MPA
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Vera Institute of Justice
34 35th St. Suite 4-2A
Brooklyn, NY 11232

EDUCATION

MPA	Princeton University, School of Public and International Affairs, Domestic Policy (Certificate in Urban Policy and Planning) 2018
PhD	University of Pennsylvania, Perelman School of Medicine, Cell and Molecular Biology (Certificate in Public Health) 2016
SB	Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Brain and Cognitive Sciences 2011

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

- Structural racism, capitalism, and health
 - Urban policy, with focus on criminal legal system and built environment
 - GIS and spatial analysis
 - Data visualization
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2025–Present	Vera Institute of Justice (Brooklyn, NY) <i>Senior Research Associate, Incarceration and Inequality Project, November 2025–present</i> • Conduct research scoping, quantitative analysis in R, and public communication documentation (i.e., explainers, press releases) for a burgeoning research program focused on the intersection of economic precarity and incarceration.
2020–2022	<i>Senior Research Associate, Reshaping Prosecution Initiative, January 2022–October 2022</i> <i>Research Associate II, Reshaping Prosecution Initiative, May 2020–January 2022</i> • Led and managed three 18-month quantitative research and data transparency projects for district attorney site partners • Built data workflows using R, SQL, and Datawrapper to extract, transform, analyze, and visualize data from each office’s relational database management system

- Authored public-facing written material and provided oral testimony for a public hearing to share policy-relevant research findings and advance local and national policy objectives
- Co-created guest lectures for reform-minded prosecutors that described the racially disparate health impacts of policing and incarceration

2022–2024

PolicyLink (Oakland, CA)

Senior Associate, National Equity Atlas, November 2022–May 2024

- Led research engagements with community partners and developed analyses, reports, and other data tools to support community-led struggles for economic equity; used both quantitative and qualitative (i.e. structured interviews) approaches
- Regularly maintained strong relationships with external consultants and community leaders

2017–2020

Metropolitan Area Planning Council (Boston, MA)

Research Analyst II, June 2018–April 2020

- Led the data analysis work for over a half dozen research efforts, with a primary focus on social vulnerability, racial and socioeconomic disparities, and residential displacement in Greater Boston. Built proficiency in R, Leaflet, and ArcGIS.
- Developed statistical clustering and classification models in R to classify housing submarkets and climate-vulnerable communities using multiple data sources; collaborated with web development team to produce online interactive maps
- Presented findings and authored policy memos and reports, research briefs, literature reviews, and technical documentation

Public Health Intern, June 2017–August 2017; January 2018

- Authored three (3) policy memos and reports evaluating the regional planning agency's role in addressing various racial and socioeconomic health disparities in the Metro Boston region.
- Compiled, analyzed, and visualized a wide range of city and regional datasets, including health, demographic, economic, housing and education data from survey and census data sources
- Helped facilitate community engagement forums on urban food policy and age-friendly housing and transportation initiatives throughout the Boston metropolitan area

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2024–2025

University of Chicago

Assistant Instructional Professor, Department of Public Health Sciences

2022–2024

University of Pennsylvania, Perelman School of Medicine

Lecturer, Master of Public Health Program

Senior Fellow, Penn Center for Public Health

TEACHING

University of Chicago

Foundations of Public Health (Graduate; 2024, 2025)

GIS and Spatial Analysis for Public Health (Graduate; 2024, 2025)

Social Inequalities in Health: Race/Ethnicity and Class in the U.S. Context (Graduate; 2025)

Introduction to Urban Health (Graduate; 2025)

Public Health in Practice (Graduate; 2024, 2025)

University of Pennsylvania

Race and Public Health (Graduate; 2022, 2024)

Journal Club Leader, Biomedical Research Academy (High School Seminar; 2016)

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

2013–2014

University of Pennsylvania, Perelman School of Medicine (Philadelphia, PA)

Lab Mentor, Spring 2013–Fall 2014

- Managed and mentored three college students and one high school student in small-scale biomedical research projects
- Wrote one letter of recommendation for student college clinical internship application

OTHER APPLIED EXPERIENCE

2015–2016

Penn Public Policy Challenge, Fels Institute of Government (Philadelphia, PA)

Finalist, November 2015–January 2016

- Worked on a multi-disciplinary team of six to develop a health insurance literacy program for West Philadelphia high school students in collaboration with local Philadelphia health literacy non-profit organizations and high school officials
- Created a comprehensive program proposal that was selected as one of the top five proposals of the challenge; presented our work to Philadelphia City Council members and prominent community stakeholders at WHYY Studios and received positive feedback

2014–2015

Energize the Chain (Philadelphia, PA)

Project Consultant, July 2014–October 2015

- Developed a comprehensive evaluation framework (log frame) to monitor and evaluate the health, economic, and social impacts of the vaccine access initiative Energize the Chain during its expansion into Ghana
- Communicated with global health and development stakeholders such as GAVI, USAID, and the Ghana Ministry of Health to determine the best means of implementing the activities prescribed in the evaluation framework

- Evaluation framework is now used by students and faculty from the University of Pennsylvania and the University of Health and Allied Sciences in Ghana as the backbone of their monitoring and evaluation efforts for the first 35 EtC implementation sites in Ghana

2014

Emory Global Health International Case Competition (Atlanta, GA)

University of Pennsylvania Team Captain, March 2014

- Led an interdisciplinary team of University of Pennsylvania PhD and undergraduate students in an international case competition against 24 universities
- Developed a proposal and oral presentation judged by public health professionals; received constructive positive feedback regarding our proposed solution

ACADEMIC RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2011–2016

University of Pennsylvania, Perelman School of Medicine (Philadelphia, PA)

PhD Candidate, August 2011–May 2016

Thesis advisor: David B. Weiner, PhD

Dissertation title: "Engineered DNA-Mediated Antibody Gene Transfer for Prophylaxis against Infectious Diseases"

- Developed an antibody delivery system that led to multiple publications and the successful acquisition of grant funding totaling over \$10 million.
- Led the Penn contingent of a multi-institution research collaboration funded by DARPA with the aim of developing novel antibody-based protective drugs against infectious diseases
- Lead author of 3 peer-reviewed research publications (co-author on 7 others)

2010–2011

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Dept. of Bioengineering and Material Science Engineering (Cambridge, MA)

Research Assistant, September 2010–April 2011

Advisor: Darrell Irvine, PhD

- Worked to develop an HIV vaccine by characterizing and analyzing the immune response in mice to micro- and nanoparticle vaccine vehicles presenting the model antigen ovalbumin.

2010

Mayo Clinic Jacksonville (Jacksonville, FL)

Summer Undergraduate Research Fellow, Summer 2010

Advisor: Nilufer Ertekin-Taner, MD, PhD

- Completed a pilot study investigating the genetic associations of select single nucleotide polymorphisms with Alzheimer's disease risk in African Americans, presenting the results of my research to over 100 Mayo Clinic physicians and researchers

2008–2010

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Dept. of Brain and Cognitive Sciences (Cambridge, MA)

Undergraduate Researcher, September 2008–May 2010

Advisor: H. Sebastian Seung, PhD

- Collaborated with a senior PhD candidate to develop a detailed research plan and protocols for an exploratory research project to determine the mechanism of transynaptic spread of rabies virus.
- Using confocal microscopy, obtained images of retinal ganglion cells and assisted in the filing and computer-assisted tracing of each individual cell to produce an encyclopedic image base for retinal neurons.

2009 **Massachusetts General Hospital, Institute of Music and Brain Science** (Cambridge, MA)
Research Assistant, Summer 2009

Advisor: Mark Tramo, MD, PhD

- Utilized MATLAB programming and music production skills to conduct clinical research focusing on the effects of music playback during “heel stick” blood tests on premature infants; worked directly with MGH nurses and bioengineers in various neonatal intensive care units.

2009 **Harvard University, Dept. of Psychology, Prosopagnosia Research Center** (Cambridge, MA)

Research Assistant, Summer 2009

Advisor: Ken Nakayama, PhD

- Assisted in optimizing prosopagnosia training software and setting up a new online research distribution model with aims to allow targeted delivery of training software to prosopagnosia sufferers via the Internet.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Wang Y*, Esquivel R*, **Flingai S***, Schiller ZA, Kern A, Agarwal S, Chu J, Patel A, Sullivan K, Wise MC, Broderick KE, Hu L, Weiner DB, Klempner MS. Anti-OspA DNA-Encoded Monoclonal Antibody Prevents Transmission of Spirochetes in Tick Challenge Providing Sterilizing Immunity in Mice. *J Infect Dis.* 2019;219(7):1146-1150. doi:10.1093/infdis/jiy627.

**co-first authors*

Flingai S. The Missegregation of the Twin Cities: How the Minnesota Land Use Planning Act of 1976 Failed to Stably Integrate the Twin Cities Metropolitan Area. *Journal of Public and International Affairs* 2018: 152-68.

Patel A, DiGiandomenico A, Keller AE, Smith TRF, Park DH, Ramos S, Schultheis K, Elliott STC, Mendoza J, Broderick KE, Wise MC, Yan J, Jiang J, **Flingai S**, Khan AS, Muthumani K, Humeau L, Cheng LI, Wachter-Rosati L, Stover CK, Sardesai NY, Weiner DB. An engineered bispecific DNA-encoded IgG antibody protects against *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* in a pneumonia challenge model. *Nat Commun* 2017;8(637). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-017-00576-7>.

Muthumani K, Block P, **Flingai S**, Muruganantham N, Chaaithanya IK, Tingey C, Wise M, Reuschel EL, Chung C, Muthumani A, Sarangan G, Srikanth P, Khan AS, Vijayachari P, Sardesai NY, Kim JJ, Ugen KE, Weiner DB. Rapid and long-term immunity elicited by DNA encoded antibody prophylaxis and DNA vaccination against Chikungunya virus. *J Infect Dis*. 2016;214(3):369-378. doi:10.1093/infdis/jiw111.

Muthumani K, Falzarano D, Reuschel EL, Tingey C, **Flingai S**, Villarreal DO, Wise M, Patel A, Izmirly A, Aljuaid A, Seliga AM, Soule G, Morrow M, Kraynyak KA, Khan AS, Scott DP, Feldmann F, LaCasse R, Meade-White K, Okumura A, Ugen KE, Sardesai NY, Kim JJ, Kobinger G, Feldmann H, Weiner DB. A synthetic consensus anti-spike protein DNA vaccine induces protective immunity against Middle East respiratory syndrome coronavirus in nonhuman primates. *Sci Transl Med*. 2015;7(301):301ra132. doi:10.1126/scitranslmed.aac7462.

Flingai S, Plummer EM, Patel A, Shrestha S, Mendoza JM, Broderick KE, Sardesai NY, Muthumani K, Weiner DB. Protection against dengue disease by synthetic nucleic acid antibody prophylaxis/immunotherapy. *Sci Rep*. 2015;5:12616. doi:10.1038/srep12616.

Lanitis E, Smith JB, Dangaj D, **Flingai S**, Poussin M, Xu S, Czerniecki BJ, Li YF, Robbins PF, Powell DJ Jr. A human ErbB2-specific T-cell receptor confers potent antitumor effector functions in genetically engineered primary cytotoxic lymphocytes. *Hum Gene Ther*. 2014;25(8):730-739. doi:10.1089/hum.2014.006.

Shedlock DJ, Tingey C, Mahadevan L, Hutnick N, Reuschel EL, Kudchodkar S, **Flingai S**, Yan J, Kim JJ, Ugen KE, Weiner DB, Muthumani K. Co-Administration of Molecular Adjuvants Expressing NF-Kappa B Subunit p65/RelA or Type-1 Transactivator T-bet Enhance Antigen Specific DNA Vaccine-Induced Immunity. *Vaccines (Basel)*. 2014;2(2):196-215. doi:10.3390/vaccines2020196.

Muthumani K, Wise MC, Broderick KE, Hutnick N, Goodman J, **Flingai S**, Yan J, Bian CB, Mendoza J, Tingey C, Wilson C, Wojtak K, Sardesai NY, Weiner DB. HIV-1 Env DNA vaccine plus protein boost delivered by EP expands B- and T-cell responses and neutralizing phenotype in vivo. *PLoS One*. 2013;8(12):e84234. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0084234.

Flingai S, Czerwonko M, Goodman J, Kudchodkar SB, Muthumani K, Weiner DB. Synthetic DNA vaccines: improved vaccine potency by electroporation and co-delivered genetic adjuvants. *Front Immunol*. 2013;4:354. doi:10.3389/fimmu.2013.00354.

Muthumani K, **Flingai S**, Wise M, Tingey C, Ugen KE, Weiner DB. Optimized and enhanced DNA plasmid vector based in vivo construction of a neutralizing anti-HIV-1 envelope glycoprotein Fab. *Hum Vaccin Immunother*. 2013;9(10):2253-2262. doi:10.4161/hv.26498.

Research Reports

Flingai S, Balcazar A, Muña E-M, Tyler GC, Tran J. “[2024 Long Island Equity Profile: A Blueprint for Regional Transformation](#),” National Equity Atlas. (July 25, 2024).

Partridge Guerrero JP, DeRosa A, **Flingai S**, Perez T, Philbrick S, Reardon R. "[Homes for Profit: Speculation and Investment in Greater Boston](#)," Metropolitan Area Planning Council. (November 2023).

Johnson A, Roberts S, Ross E, Onyekwere A, **Flingai S**, Battle N, Castañeda S, Taylor A, Quiles J, Darwiche S, Sahaf M. "[Pushing Forward: Prosecution Reform and Racial Equity across Six Counties](#)," Vera Institute of Justice. (July 19, 2023).

Flingai S, Sahaf M, Battle N, Castañeda S. "[An Analysis of Racial Disparities in Police Traffic Stops in Suffolk County, Massachusetts, from 2010 to 2019](#)," Vera Institute of Justice. (June 27, 2022).

Flingai S. "[Framework for Residential Displacement Research at MAPC: Definitions and Approaches](#)," MAPC MetroCommon 2050, Metropolitan Area Planning Council. (March 4, 2021).

Flingai S, Reardon T, Fine M, Partridge Guerrero J, Adelman K (ed.). "[The Diversity Deficit: Municipal Employees in Metro Boston](#)," MAPC MetroCommon 2050, Metropolitan Area Planning Council. (July 13, 2020).

Stucker H, **Flingai S**, Keppard B. "[Health Lens Analysis of Urban Agriculture Policy: Cambridge, MA](#)," Metropolitan Area Planning Council (February 2019).

Blumauer C, Brown A, Castaldi M, **Flingai S**, Hernandez P, Mavronis S, Pierce K, Stanley-Becker T, Stockdale J. "[Advancing Bail Reform in Maryland: Progress and Possibilities](#)," School of Public and International Affairs, Princeton University. (February 27, 2018).

Op-Eds and Public Writing

Flingai S. "[Racism in traffic stops is real, and the data backs it up](#)," *Boston Herald*. (February 25, 2022).

Hodge J, **Flingai S**. "[What Happened When Boston Stopped Prosecuting Nonviolent Crimes](#)," *Think Justice* Blog, Vera Institute of Justice. (April 2, 2021).

Research Projects

[At What Cost? Examining Police, Sheriff, and Jail Budgets Across the US](#) (Project Manager), National Equity Atlas and Civilytics Consulting. (September 8, 2023).

[MAPC Housing Submarkets](#) (Lead Researcher), MAPC MetroCommon 2050, Metropolitan Area Planning Council. (February 25, 2021).

[Climate Vulnerability in Greater Boston](#) (Lead Researcher and Co-Author), MAPC MetroCommon 2050, Metropolitan Area Planning Council. (December 10, 2019).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentation, "Data-Driven Health Equity: A Guide to Unleashing the Power of the National Equity Atlas," State of Black Health 2023 National Conference. San Juan, PR. (September 2023).

Oral Presentation, "Mapping Climate Vulnerability in Greater Boston," National Neighborhood Indicators Partnership 2019 Meeting. Milwaukee, WI. (June 2019).

Poster Presentation, "Housing, Economic Hardship, and Maternal Depression: A Subgroup Analysis," Population Association of America 2019 Annual Meeting. Austin, TX. (April 2019).

Poster Presentation, "Generation of DNA Plasmid-Encoded Neutralizing Monoclonal Antibodies in vivo," American Society of Gene and Cell Therapy 19th Annual Meeting. Washington, DC. (May 2016).

Poster Presentation, "Protection against dengue disease by intramuscular delivery of DNA encoding anti-dengue neutralizing antibodies," PEGS 2015. Boston, MA. (May 2015).

Poster Presentation, "Protection against dengue disease by intramuscular delivery of DNA encoding anti-dengue neutralizing antibodies," American Society of Gene and Cell Therapy 18th Annual Meeting. New Orleans, LA. (May 2015).

Poster Presentation, "Generation of DNA Plasmid-Encoded Broadly Neutralizing Antibodies in vivo," American Society of Gene and Cell Therapy 17th Annual Meeting. Washington, DC. (May 2014).

Oral and Poster Presentation, "Generation of DNA Plasmid-Encoded Broadly Neutralizing Antibodies in vivo," Keystone Symposium on Prophylactic and Therapeutic Antibodies. Keystone, CO. (February 2014).

INVITED TALKS AND ENGAGEMENTS

Speaker, "Data and Evaluation," Results for America Diversion Done Right Solutions Sprint. (September 24, 2025).

Speaker, "Neoliberalism and Health in the United States," University of Illinois at Chicago Family Medicine Vulnerable Populations Didactics Seminar. (July 23, 2025).

Judge, Lake Forest College 2024-2025 Public Policy Analysis Challenge: Addressing Addiction. (April 27, 2025).

Speaker, "Mapping Climate Vulnerability: A Regional, People-Centered Approach," University of Pennsylvania 2023 GIS & Public Health Winter Institute. (January 9, 2023).

Speaker, "Mapping Climate Vulnerability: A Regional, People-Centered Approach," University of Pennsylvania 2021 Summer Institute: GIS & Public Health. (June 18, 2021).

Speaker, “Gathering and managing data: The how and why,” Middlesex County District Attorney’s Office Data Summit. (June 4, 2021).

Panelist, “Transformative Justice,” Princeton School of Public and International Affairs Students and Alumni of Color (SAOC) Symposium 2021. (April 10, 2021).

Speaker, “The Diversity Deficit: Municipal Employees in Metro Boston,” MAPC MetroCommon 2050 Research Release. (July 14, 2020).

Speaker, “Social Vulnerability to Climate Change in Greater Boston,” MAPC Clean Energy Forum. (December 11, 2019).

Speaker, “Assessing Residential Displacement in Greater Boston: Initial Steps,” MAPC presentation for the Healthy Neighborhood Study Research Consortium. (May 17, 2019).

Speaker, “MetroWest Health Foundation Trends and Projections,” MAPC presentation for the MetroWest Health Foundation. (November 16, 2018).

Speaker, “MAPC Creative Economy Indicator Data Project,” MAPC presentation for the Massachusetts Cultural Data Working Group. (August 23, 2018).

Panelist, “Dom Time” television program with Dom Giordano: panel discussion on vaccine safety and their importance in America’s public health. (August 5, 2013).

SERVICE

Professional Service

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| 2021–2022 | <u>Black Verans Council, Vera Institute of Justice</u>
<i>Member, Spring 2021–Spring 2022</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Supported internal programming for fellow Black employees of the Vera Institute that aimed to build fellowship and facilitate professional development over a remote working environment |
| 2021 | <u>Justice Counts prosecution subcommittee, The Council of State Governments</u>
<i>Member, Spring 2021–Summer 2021</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Provided expertise on the development of prosecution-focused, equity-minded, policy-relevant criminal justice metrics for the Justice Counts initiative |
| 2019–2020 | <u>Equity Team, Metropolitan Area Planning Council</u>
<i>Member, Spring 2019–Spring 2020</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Facilitated agency-wide teach-ins, panel screenings, and reading discussions on racial justice issues that touched on the multitudinous work of urban and regional planners |

University Service

Princeton University, School of Public and International Affairs

- 2016–2018 Students and Alumni of Color (SAOC)
Co-Chair, Fall 2017–Spring 2018
Symposium Planning Co-Chair, Fall 2016–Spring 2017
- Developed year-round programming and networking opportunities for students of color, including an Alumni Dinner Series and a Student + Alumni Networking Reception (2018)
 - Led the planning and recruitment of panelists for one of two panels for the 21st Annual Student and Alumni of Color Symposium (2017)
- 2016–2017 Princeton University Policy Student Government
Student Co-Representative, Domestic Policy field, Fall 2016–Spring 2017
- Co-developed an annual budget and series of community-building and networking events for students in the Domestic Policy field of concentration

University of Pennsylvania, Perelman School of Medicine

- 2013–2016 Ernest E. Just Biomedical Society
President, Summer 2015–Spring 2016
Vice President, Summer 2014–Spring 2015
Outreach Chair, Summer 2013–Spring 2014
- Served as president of Penn’s underrepresented minority biomedical graduate student organization, serving the post-baccalaureate, master’s, and doctoral student population
 - As President, managed the Executive Board and led monthly Executive and General Assembly meetings
 - Led the development of the organization’s annual agenda and spearheaded new initiatives in community outreach, student professional development activities, cross-campus collaboration, and online presence
 - Oversaw a \$14,000 budget and ensured that expenditures and events were congruent with the organization’s missions and goals
- 2015–2016 Penn Science Diplomacy Group
Founding Board Member, Fall 2015–Spring 2016
- Provided expertise on organizational structure and helped to establish the organization’s budget
 - Developed the organization’s website and online networking infrastructure